



Pentagon planning polygraphs, NDAs to stop leaks

BY ALEX HORTON,
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AND ELLEN NAKASHIMA

The Pentagon plans to impose strict nondisclosure agreements and random polygraph testing for scores of people in its headquarters, including many top officials, according to two people familiar with the proposal and documents obtained by The Washington Post, escalating Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth's war on leakers and in-

Part of administration's effort to oust those seen as insufficiently loyal

ternal dissent.

All military service members, civilian employees and contract workers within the office of the defense secretary and the Joint Staff, estimated to be more than

5,000 personnel, would be required to sign a nondisclosure agreement that "prohibits the release of non-public information without approval or through a defined process," according to a draft memo from Deputy Defense Secretary Steve Feinberg.

A separate document also from Feinberg would establish a program to randomly polygraph those officials. The documents do not prescribe a limit on who would be subjected to these agree-

ments and tests, suggesting it could include everyone from four-star generals to administrative assistants.

The efforts are part of a wider strategy by the Trump administration and the Pentagon to ferret out officials deemed insufficiently loyal or who provide information to reporters.

Chief Pentagon spokesperson Sean Parnell declined to answer questions about the new planned

SEE PENTAGON ON A8

Administration flexes its power during shutdown

BLAMING DEMOCRATS, IT WARNS OF LAYOFFS

White House blocks blue-state infrastructure projects

BY JACOB BOGAGE,
RILEY BEGGIN,
HANNAH NATANSON
AND OLIVIA GEORGE

The Trump administration began to exert its power over the government shutdown Wednesday, blaming Democrats for imminent layoffs of federal workers, tying up infrastructure projects in blue states, and posting partisan messages on government websites that deflected blame for the stoppage in crucial federal services.

Most federal government functions were halted after funding ran out and Congress deadlocked over how to extend spending laws.

Vice President JD Vance said that officials were "going to have to lay some people off" during a prolonged shutdown to prioritize funding for essential services, though the size of the federal workforce is unrelated to the country's financial health during

a lapse in funding.

Senate Democrats on Tuesday blocked a Republican bill that would have extended federal resources for seven weeks. Republicans in the chamber blocked a Democratic bill that would have done the same while also extending subsidies for health insurance coverage. The GOP bill failed again in a Wednesday vote. Congress will be off Thursday for Yom Kippur, the Jewish day of atonement.

The two sides, and the White House, have dug in.

"Donald Trump and Republicans have barreled us into a

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A7

Democrats: In a risky move, party cheers on shutdown strategy. **A6**

Health care: Dispute over ACA subsidies at heart of impasse. **A6**

In the D.C. area: The museums and historic sites that will shut. **B13**

Scores killed in Philippines earthquake



ELOISA LOPEZ/REUTERS

A 6.9-magnitude temblor in the central Philippines killed at least 69 people, authorities said, with casualty numbers expected to rise. Above, a victim's body is recovered Wednesday in the city of Bogo. **Story, A10**

Trump fires most members of humanities council

BY JANAY KINGSBERRY,
KELSEY ABLES
AND TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

The White House on Wednesday abruptly fired a large share of the council members advising the National Endowment for the Humanities, retaining only four appointees of President Donald

Trump, according to terminated members reached by The Washington Post and an updated list on the agency's website.

"On behalf of President Donald J. Trump, I am writing to inform you that your position as a member of the National Council on the Humanities is terminated, effective immediately,"

read an email sent to council members Wednesday morning, according to a copy reviewed by The Post. "Thank you for your service."

The letter was signed by Mary Sprowls of the White House Presidential Personnel Office.

A White House spokesperson told The Post in an email that the

president is "hoping to place members on the board who align more closely with his vision."

The National Council on the Humanities, a board of 26 scholars and humanities leaders appointed by the president to six-year terms, advises the chair of the NEH on grantmaking, policy

SEE HUMANITIES ON A2

Some leaders alarmed as patrols continue despite end of Trump emergency

BY EMMA UBER
AND TEO ARMUS

Immigration authorities are continuing to patrol the District with D.C. police weeks after the expiration of President Donald Trump's order placing city police under federal control, leaving some local leaders and residents alarmed and confused about D.C. police's role in immigration enforcement.

The department — which has for years been restricted by D.C. law from cooperating with immigration authorities — was compelled to aid in immigration en-

forcement during the 30-day emergency Trump declared in August to fight crime. When the emergency ended Sept. 10, D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) said at a news conference that "immigration enforcement is not what MPD does, and with the end of the emergency, it won't be what MPD does in the future."

The Washington Post reviewed photos and videos of at least half a dozen incidents since Sept. 10. They show D.C. police officers with masked agents in vests — labeled HSI for Homeland Security Investigations — and D.C. police cruisers parked beside vehicles marked "U.S. Customs and Border Protection." In two of those videos, men detained by D.C. police ended up in U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement custody and remain in ICE detention centers.

SEE IMMIGRATION ON A8

Cook can remain on Fed board for now, justices rule

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL
AND ANDREW ACKERMAN

The Supreme Court on Wednesday ruled that Federal Reserve governor Lisa Cook can remain in her job for now and announced it will take up a high-stakes case over President Donald Trump's attempt to remove her from the central bank.

The court will hear arguments in the case in January, and its temporary ruling will last at least until then. Lower courts allowed Cook to keep her position. The Trump administration had asked the high court to overturn those decisions and allow Trump to remove Cook immediately.

The high court's decision to hear the case sets up a showdown over the independence of the central bank, which sets interest rates and is tasked with taming inflation. The case could have major ramifications for businesses and consumers.

The provisional ruling to allow

Cook to keep her job signals hesitation from at least some of the justices regarding the president's aggressive campaign to oust Cook and gain tighter control over the Fed. Her removal would have required affirmative votes from at least five of the nine justices.

Columbia law professor Lev Menand called the court's move "quite consequential," even though the justices offered no detailed reasoning to explain their two-sentence order. By delaying a ruling on the administration's request, the justices handed Cook a win.

"It's not a definitive victory," he said. "It just buys Lisa Cook a significant amount of additional time in office, contrary to the president's wishes to displace her."

Menand joined other academics in a friend-of-the-court brief supporting Cook, arguing that allowing the president to

SEE COOK ON A14

A friend to chimpanzees, she revolutionized primatology

BY EMMA BROWN

Jane Goodall had no scientific training, not even a college degree, when, at 23, she saved up money to visit a friend in Kenya. She was a London secretary and sometimes waitress with a restless spirit and romantic fixation on animals and Africa based mostly on the "Doctor Dolittle" and "Tarzan" novels of her childhood.

An encounter in Nairobi with the eminent paleoanthropologist Louis Leakey altered the course of her life, setting her on an unlikely path to becoming the world's foremost primatologist. Her startling observations about chimpanzee behaviors — from making tools to making war — revolutionized not only scientific understanding of the capabilities and inner lives of our simian cousins, but also long-held notions about what it means to be human.

Dr. Goodall, whose research prompted a transformation in the

Her work has been described as among the 'Western world's great scientific achievements'



JEAN-MARC BOUJUP/AP

Jane Goodall plays with the chimpanzee Bahati at the Sweetwaters Chimpanzee Sanctuary near Nanyuki, north of Nairobi, in 1997.

IN THE NEWS

Gaza City Israel has stepped up its assault as Hamas considers a peace deal and a flotilla carrying activists including Greta Thunberg was intercepted en route to the enclave. **A12**

Leo weighs in on U.S. politics In a rare move, the pope commented on this week's military gathering, which he called "concerning." **A11**

THE NATION

A decline in interstate travel for abortions this year may point to higher pill use, a report said. **A4**
Six homes in the Outer Banks fell into the ocean as two hurricanes churned offshore. **A4**

THE WORLD

A bomb threat paused Munich's Oktoberfest, officials said, and a suspect killed himself. **A11**
A nuclear plant in Ukraine has been on emergency power for more than a week. **A12**

THE ECONOMY

Walmart, the world's largest retailer, will stop using synthetic dyes and certain other food additives in its private-label offerings. **A13**
Americans have a greater share of resources in the stock market than ever, Federal Reserve data shows. **A13**

STYLE

Cancel culture, once vilified by conservatives as part of a "woke" agenda, has become a bipartisan tool. **B1**

SPORTS

Jayden Daniels has been medically cleared and could return for the Commanders in Sunday's game. **B7**

THE REGION

WorldPride generated less revenue than expected, said D.C. leaders and organizers of the LGBTQ+ event. **B13**

LOCAL LIVING

The first rule to hosting a child's birthday party without an adult meltdown: Worry less about the rules.

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